Other ways of grouping organisms

There are all sorts of features that can help us organise groups of living things. Organisms can be grouped by biological classification, but they can also be grouped by where they live (**habitat**), what they eat or how they behave. For example, the blue-billed duck (*Oxyura australis*) is grouped with other birds in the Class Aves (Birds), but it could also be grouped with Australian wetland creatures.

Many different types of organisms can live together in the same habitat. Some organisms that share the same living area depend on each other for their survival. For example, organisms that live on coral reefs are **interdependent**, which means that they all need each other to survive. Some organisms are food for others, while some provide shelter or protection to other species.

☞ **1** Read the passage and underline all the plants and animals mentioned.

A coral reef is home to many different types of life. Reefs contain lots of different species of fish. These fish eat the seaweed and grasses that grow on the coral. It is important that there is a rich supply of food for all the reef's creatures. Sharks and other predators eat large fish, which in turn eat smaller fish. All sorts of plants and animals live in tropical reef habitats. They include eels, crabs, prawns, sea stars, seahorses, plankton, seaweed, anemones, clownfish, angelfish, coral polyps, sea turtles, jellyfish, dolphins, dugongs and whales.

2 How many of these living things can be classified in the Animal Kingdom? List them here. Hint: List them only once each, even if they are mentioned more than once in the passage.

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Other ways of grouping organisms CONT'D

3 Which three things can be classified in the Plant Kingdom?

_____

_____

4 List any that you are unsure about.

_____

_____

5 Circle the odd one out in each group of living creatures.

a)	fish	plankton	shark
b)	seaweed	anemone	dolphin
c)	turtle	crab	jellyfish
d)	sea star	angelfish	large fish
e)	clown fish	seahorse	horse

6 For each of your answers in Question 5, list the difference or differences that make that organism the odd one out.

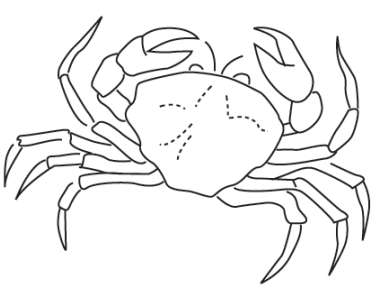
a) _____

b) _____

c) _____

d) _____

e) _____



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